Hatfield Forest District Scouts Survive Essex County Backpack at Thorrington

rmp

Last weekend, the quiet trails around **Thorrington Camp Site** were transformed into a sea of neon yellow and hiking boots as six hundred young people took part in the annual **Essex Scouts County Backpack**. Among those braving the elements and the miles were the dedicated scouts from **Hatfield Forest District**, specifically teams from **1st Dunmow** and **1st Henham & Elsenham**.



The event is a challenging test of navigation, endurance, and teamwork even in the flatlands of Essex. Strategically planning their routes from base to base, the Scouts navigated through the Essex countryside over the Saturday and Sunday, visiting as many manned bases as possible - including a picturesque stop at the historic All Saints Church in Brightlingsea - before returning to the main campsite at Thorrington.



Putting Hatfield Forest on the Leaderboard

Both the Dunmow and Henham & Elsenham (H&E) groups put in a fantastic showing across the Novice and Assisted categories. With dozens of teams competing from across the county, our local Scouts held their own with some impressive final scores:

Novice Category

Position	Group	Team	Score	Journeys	Duration
17	1st Henham & Elsenham	110	365	11	8h18
20	1st Dunmow	131	350	10	5h47

Assisted Category

Position	Group	Team	Score	Journeys	Duration
23	1st Dunmow	537	340	10	8h35
35	1st Dunmow	538	293	9	7h33
36	1st Henham & Elsenham	516	288	8	8h30
41	1st Dunmow	536	269	9	6h34
48	1st Henham & Elsenham	539	240	7	6h1

A Weekend of Adventure

The competition wasn't just about the numbers; it was about the experience. The campsite at Thorrington was a hive of activity, with tents of all the groups packed in very tightly.



Thankfully the weather was generally very good even considering a short sharp hailstorm on Saturday. Despite the cold starts and long treks through open fields and muddy paths, the scenery around Brightlingsea and Wivenhoe is pretty in Spring and spirits remained high.



At the end of the grueling weekend on the trails, the Scouts gathered around the campfire circle for the prizegiving before setting off home.

Whether they were at the front of the pack or simply focused on finishing the course, every Scout from **1st Dunmow** and **1st Henham & Elsenham** showed incredible resilience. They return home with sore feet and muddy gear, but with a massive sense of achievement and the drive to take part again next year.

Huge thanks to all the leaders who gave up their weekend to assist, and congratulations to all the participants!

